

English Language

(A Level, Edexcel Pearson)

The study of English Language or Linguistics will help you understand how people communicate and assign meaning (semantics), how they do things with words (pragmatics) or how language relates to social factors (sociolinguistics), psychological aspects (psycholinguistics), or power and injustice (discourse analysis). Studying these subjects will open your eyes to a world that has previously been hidden in plain sight.

By studying language in depth (using data and theoretical frameworks), you will develop critical awareness and gain invaluable skills for your future working life – vital communication, analytical and critical skills. But importantly, such critical awareness will allow you to be a conscious, critical human being who is able to challenge taken-for-granted assumptions, understand the role of language in social control, propaganda and manipulation, and be able to use this understanding to make the world a less oppressive, more equal and just place.

Entry Requirements:

Grade 5 in GCSE English.

Course Content

Units	%	Content
Component 1: Language Variation 2 hours 15 minutes	35%	Individual Variation • One 30-mark essay question on two unseen 21st-century linked texts/data. • Candidates explore how language choices reflect and construct identity. Variation over Time • One 30-mark essay question on two thematically linked texts/data from two different periods. • Candidates explore variation in the English language from 1550 to present day
Component 2: Child Language 1 hour 15 minutes	20%	Child Language Acquisition • One section. One 45-mark essay based on a set of unseen data. • Exploration of language acquisition between the ages of 0 and 8. • Phonemic symbols and signs provided.
Component 3: Investigating Language 1 hour 45 minutes	25%	Investigating Language • Candidates select a research focus from five topic areas with a subtopic pre-release in December and undertake their own independent research. • Section A: one 15-mark question on unseen data from the subtopic candidates have researched. • Section B: one 30-mark question from the subtopic candidates have researched making links to their own investigation.
Non-Examined Assessment: Crafting Language	20%	Crafting Language • Candidates produce two assignments. • Assignment 1 – two pieces of original writing from the same genre. • Assignment 2 – one commentary reflecting on the two pieces of original writing. • 2500-3000 words.

Career Links

English is particularly desirable for working in Journalism and Publishing; Marketing; Education and Training; Counselling and Social Services; Advertising and Management and Speech and Language Therapy. It is increasingly considered a desirable social science needed within an increasingly digitalised society.

For more information please contact Miss Jackson